

ALVIN M. SILVA, MDM

Evidence-to-Policy | Government Partnerships | Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Development management professional with 15+ years of experience strengthening the use of data and evidence in public policy and government program delivery in the Philippines and across Asia, including lower- and middle-income country (LMIC) contexts. Spent three years embedded in the Office of the Chairman of the Metro Manila Development Authority (MMDA), advising on policy and managing evaluation studies for a metropolitan region of 13M+ residents. Designed and managed results-based management and monitoring and evaluation (M&E) programs for senior government officials in five countries, and led mixed-methods reviews, situational assessments, and policy reviews for WHO, GIZ, ECHO, USAID, The Asia Foundation, and the German and Philippine Red Cross. Skilled at drawing policy lessons from research and communicating them to government, donor, and community audiences through case studies, toolkits, process manuals, and training. Associate Member, National Research Council of the Philippines (NRCP-DOST); Master in Development Management, Asian Institute of Management (ADB Scholar).

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Use of Data and Evidence in Policymaking:** evidence-informed policy, policy and literature review, evidence reviews, drawing policy lessons from research, policy briefs
- **Government Engagement:** embedded technical assistance, government partnerships, institutionalization of data systems, managing up and across
- **Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL):** results frameworks, KPIs, baseline and needs assessments, mid-term reviews, results-based management
- **Research and Analysis:** mixed-methods design, survey design and quantitative analysis, qualitative inquiry (KIIs, FGDs), data analytics for development, research ethics
- **Knowledge Management and Training:** case studies, toolkits, process manuals, onboarding and training design, adult learning and facilitation
- **Project Management and Technical Assistance:** design through implementation, multi-country programs, team supervision, donor reporting and deliverable management
- **Business Development and External Engagement:** proposal design and fundraising, partnership building, convening summits, workshops, technical working groups, and roundtables
- **Sectors:** education (basic education, TVET, higher education), social protection and social safety nets, livelihoods and financial inclusion, disaster risk reduction and climate resilience, health and mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS)

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Evidence inside government:** Embedded for three years in the MMDA Office of the Chairman, reviewing and enhancing Metro Manila plans and policies and managing evaluation studies with external consultants.
- **Social protection targeting:** Reviewed the vulnerability indicators and targeting criteria of local government social safety net programs for the most vulnerable urban poor in Mindanao (ECHO / Action Against Hunger, 2021).
- **Government M&E capacity:** Designed and managed the Certificate Course on Monitoring and Evaluation for Results in partnership with UNICEF and the Department of Budget and Management (DBM).
- **From baseline to system:** Produced and published the Baseline and Needs Assessment Survey Report that anchored De La Salle University's Organizational Unit Performance Management System, delivered within two months (Jul–Aug 2024).
- **Research-to-policy convening:** Facilitated the City Futures Lab, aligning higher education institutions' research agendas with city governments' development priorities (Inclusive Growth School, 2020–2021).
- **Resource mobilization:** Designed community-based, climate-smart resilience project proposals worth PHP 190M (SOLHUM Project, 2024–2025).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Consultant – Investment Roadmap and Pipeline Development

Bureau of Investments, Ministry of Trade, Investments, and Tourism (MTIT) – BARMM | 2025 – Present

- Co-architect the Bangsamoro Investment Roadmap 2026–2035 (BIRD), working alongside government counterparts to translate economic, risk, and stakeholder evidence into a decadal investment framework aligned with national PPP law (RA 11966) and international financing mechanisms.

- Designed the BIRD digital validation platform, an offline-capable survey covering 16 assessment sections with formula-based scoring, that converts stakeholder input into ranked, decision-ready investment priorities.
- Lead multi-stakeholder consultations with LGUs, private investors, and development partners; integrated gender equality, disability, and social inclusion (GEDSI) and informal-sector inclusion into pipeline design.

Facilitator-Author, National Strategic Plan

WorldSkills Philippines – Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) | 2025 – 2026

- Authored the WSP-TESDA Strategic Plan 2026–2030 for the national technical and vocational education and training (TVET) quality agenda, integrating risk-informed governance and ESG alignment.
- Facilitated participatory strategy formulation and designed the strategy map and strategic options coherent with the national TVET landscape and global program priorities.

Lead Consultant – Climate-Smart Resilience

Fundacion de Religiosos para la Salud (SOLHUM Project) | Dec 2024 – Jan 2025

- Designed community-based, climate-smart resilience project proposals worth PHP 190M for disaster-affected populations in Camarines Sur, integrating climate adaptation, DRR, and livelihood resilience.

Founder and Lead Systems Design and Innovation Consultant

Cognitio+ | Jul 2020 – Present

- Founded and lead Cognitio+, an inclusive well-being platform delivering accessible mental health, resilience, and learning services for underserved and excluded populations; lead data governance, partnerships, and team management.
- Built tools that help institutions use data in decisions: Strat Planner Pro (AI-assisted strategic planning and performance monitoring) and DDRIVE-M (risk monitoring aligned with RA 10121, ISO 31000, and UNDRR frameworks).

Lead Consultant – Organizational Performance Systems

De La Salle University Manila (via Cognitio+) | Jul 2024 – Aug 2024

- Led the team that designed the Organizational Unit Performance Management System (OU-PMS) for the Finance and Administration Group.
- Designed, deployed, and published a Baseline and Needs Assessment Survey Report that established the evidence base and performance indicators for the system.

Lead Consultant – Local Governance and Risk-Informed Planning

Local Government Unit of Salcedo, Eastern Samar | Feb 2024 – May 2024

- Facilitated and published the Risk-Informed Comprehensive Development Plan 2023–2028, integrating multi-hazard, vulnerability, and climate risk data into long-term local planning.

Consultant – Platforms, Systems, Training, and M&E

World Health Organization (WHO) / Department of Health (DOH) | Aug 2023 – Oct 2023

- Conducted a needs assessment and designed tailored capacity-building programs and M&E frameworks for emergency health systems.
- Developed the MHPSS Intervention Module for Emergency Medical Responders, co-published with WHO and DOH.

Consultant – Integrated Risk Management

Bangsamoro Development Agency / European Union / AECID | Jul 2022 – Oct 2022

- Designed review instruments and an integrated risk assessment tool, pilot-tested them with partner CSOs in selected barangay LGUs, analyzed results, and iterated before rollout.
- Trained and coached CSOs and barangay officials on tool use; submitted a consolidated report of findings and recommendations.

Lead Consultant – Strategic Directions

The Asia Foundation / USAID (FORWARD Project) | Jul 2022 – Aug 2022

- Formulated the Vision, Mission, Goals, and Objectives (VMGO), key strategic indicators, scenario-based development framework, and action plan of the Bangsamoro Development Agency.

Lead Consultant – Systems Innovation, Food Security and Livelihoods

USAID / Action Against Hunger Philippines | Mar 2022 – May 2022

- Led empathy mapping and absorptive capacity analysis; prototyped and iterated an integrated rapid assessment and planning tool for food security, DRR, and WASH in BARMM.

Lead Consultant – Mid-Term Review, CONSENT DRR II

German Red Cross / Philippine Red Cross | Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

- Led a mixed-methods mid-term review and participatory conflict assessment using online surveys, key informant interviews (KIIs), focus group discussions (FGDs), and stakeholder validation sessions in Mindanao communities and schools.
- Delivered conflict-sensitive recommendations to strengthen the remaining implementation of DRR-CCA and peacebuilding activities.

Moderator – Impact Evaluation of Local Language Use in Information Campaigns

Ateneo Policy Center, Ateneo School of Government | Nov 2021 – Feb 2022

- Conducted and moderated focus group discussions in the local language for an impact evaluation study; safeguarded the confidentiality of all research records.

Associate Director for Training and Capacity Building

Inclusive Growth School – CIVIKA Asian Development Academy | Aug 2020 – Dec 2021

- Facilitated the City Futures Lab, convening city governments, higher education institutions, the private sector, and social innovators to align university research agendas with city development priorities; led the Resiliency Lab.
- Designed certificate courses on inclusive business and growth with partner universities; recruited faculty and mentors; designed and conducted course evaluations.

Lead Consultant – MOVE UP Projects 3 and 4

European Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid Operations (ECHO) / Action Against Hunger | Sep 2019 – May 2021

- Reviewed the vulnerability indicators and targeting criteria of LGU social safety net programs for the most vulnerable and at-risk urban poor in Mindanao.
- Assessed shock-responsive livelihood options and authored the Process Manual to Strengthen Shock-Responsive, Resilient, and Sustainable Livelihoods for LGU use.
- Reviewed national, sub-national, and city policies on urban resilience in Metro Manila; facilitated policy-integration workshops with city governments, academe, legislators, and DRRM offices.

Development Management Consultant

Metro Manila Development Authority (MMDA), Office of the Chairman | Aug 2017 – Dec 2020

- Served as embedded advisor to the Office of the Chairman on corporate and development strategy, policy, and communication for a metropolitan region of 13M+ residents.
- Reviewed and enhanced plans and policies covering DRRM, urban resilience, program and project management, and corporate planning; managed evaluation studies with external consultants.

Consultant-Facilitator, Operations and Maintenance Training

Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) Field Office 3 – KALAHI-CIDSS | Jun 2019 – Sep 2019

- Designed a capacity-building program and delivered a four-day training with on-site coaching for community associations sustaining completed KALAHI-CIDSS subprojects across Region III.

Development Executive Programs Manager

Asian Institute of Management – Zuellig School of Development Management | Jun 2013 – Sep 2017

- Designed and managed multi-country executive programs for senior government officials of Bhutan, Timor-Leste, Lao PDR, Vietnam, and the Philippines, including Results-Based Management for senior managers through the Office of the Prime Minister of Bhutan.
- Designed and managed the Certificate Course on Monitoring and Evaluation for Results with UNICEF and DBM, and managed the Executive Master in Development Management (Public Finance) with the Department of Finance.
- Managed education governance programs: Strengthening Delivery and Governance of Education for DepEd Regions IX and X and the Top Management Program for Higher Education Institutions during the K to 12 transition; supported the DFAT-funded evaluation mission of DepEd's Basic Education Planning System and Enhanced School Improvement Planning.

Earlier Career (2005 – 2013)

- **Assistant Program Manager**, Eastern Visayas Area Cooperation for Health (EU-funded), 2012–2013: managed daily operations; supervised area coordinators and administrative staff; managed budgets and evaluation studies.
- **Component Manager**, DISOP International, 2008–2010: managed curriculum development and implementation for 10 Family Farm Schools, an alternative education system for rural youth.
- **Area Coordinator and Community Facilitator**, DSWD KALAHI-CIDSS, Northern and Eastern Samar, 2005–2008: managed a team of civil engineers, finance analysts, and community facilitators implementing community-driven development projects.

EDUCATION

Master in Development Management (MDM) | Asian Institute of Management, ADB Scholar, Dec 2011. Specialization: Public Finance, Systems Thinking, Development Leadership, Institutional Risk Governance

Master in Rural Development | Eastern Visayas State University

B.S. Social Sciences, Major in Political Science | University of the Philippines Visayas – Tacloban College

CIVIL SERVICE ELIGIBILITY

- Career Service Professional Eligibility (Second Level)
- Career Executive Service Written Examination Passer

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Data Analytics for Development (Full Track), Development Academy of the Philippines and DOST, Project SPARTA (2021, 40 hrs)
- u.lab: Leading from the Emerging Future, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (2021, 45 hrs)
- Technology Entrepreneurship: Lab to Market, Harvard University (2021, 30 hrs)
- Public Service Continuity Planning Facilitator, USAID, PDRF, NDRRMC, and OCD (2021, 32 hrs)
- Security Risk Management Professional (SRMP), INSSA Country Level Certification (2022, 40 hrs)
- Certified Resilient Mental Health and Wellbeing Facilitator, NZ MFAT and PDRF (2021); Psychological First Aid Facilitator, DisasterReady.org (2021)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND KNOWLEDGE PRODUCTS

- Review of Vulnerability Indicators and Criteria in LGU Social Safety Net Programs Targeting the Most Vulnerable and At-Risk Urban Poor (ECHO / Action Against Hunger, 2021, Lead Consultant)
- Process Manual to Strengthen Shock-Responsive, Resilient, and Sustainable Livelihoods (ECHO / Action Against Hunger, 2021, Lead Consultant)
- Mid-Term Review and Participatory Conflict Assessment, CONSENT DRR II (German Red Cross / Philippine Red Cross, 2022, Lead Consultant)
- MHPSS Intervention Module for Emergency Medical Responders (WHO / DOH, 2023, Co-Author)
- Enhancing Agriculture and Fishery Sectors in Sulu and Maguindanao del Norte: A Comprehensive Situational Assessment (GIZ, 2023, Co-Author)
- Enhancing Performance Management at DLSU: Baseline and Needs Assessment Report (Cognitio+, 2024, Author)
- Review of Sub-National Policies and Integrating Urban Resilience of Vulnerable Communities in Metro Manila (ECHO / Action Against Hunger, 2020, Lead Consultant)
- Building Resilience: The Path to a More Fulfilling and Resilient Life (Cognitio+, 2023, Author); 2024 SME Report (ASilva Innovations, 2024, Author)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS AND MENTORSHIP

- Associate Member, National Research Council of the Philippines (NRCP-DOST); validated as researcher-practitioner in program and project development and management, DRR, and inclusive growth
- Mentor and Coach, Asian Institute of Management Graduate Mentorship Program, Cycles 5 and 6 (2023–2024)
- Head of Asia-Pacific Region, Diversity for Crisis Global Online Hackathon (2020): mobilized hundreds of participants with country representatives and expert advisers